

Wild Caving Experience in Melouri Cave

Trade daylight for headlamps — cross an underground river into the wild heart of the Georgian karst.

- **Region:** Imereti — near Kutaisi (Tskaltubo area), Georgia
- **Activity:** Wild caving — wading, scrambling, total darkness
- **Duration:** 3–5 hours inside the cave — a full-day activity overall
- **Difficulty:** Moderate — no experience needed

Overview

Melouri Cave is wild caving in its truest form — no handrails, no walkways, no coloured lights. Just you, a helmet and headlamp, a certified guide, and the living dark of the Georgian karst near Kutaisi. This is an "active" cave: you'll cross an underground river, pick your way past rock formations, and move through chambers where the only sound is dripping water and your own breath.

It's an adventure, but an accessible one — no previous caving experience is required, and your guide leads every step, reading the cave and keeping the group safe. You'll get a little muddy, you'll scramble a little, and you'll come out grinning. You stay mostly dry — the boots we provide keep your feet dry, and you only step across the water rather than walk through it. A perfect half-day of real underground exploration for anyone based in or passing through Imereti — and a strong add-on to a western-Georgia trip.

Melouri has many possible routes, so the difficulty and length are tailored to your group — your guide picks the line that fits your fitness, experience and appetite for adventure. You'll spend roughly 3–5 hours underground.

You can join from Kutaisi as a roughly five-hour experience, or from Tbilisi as a long full day (Kutaisi is about 3.5–4 hours' drive each way). Choose your pickup point when you book. Not recommended for those with serious claustrophobia or significant mobility limits — see the FAQ.

Highlights

- Explore a genuine wild cave — not a paved show-cave
- Cross an underground river (boots provided — you stay mostly dry)
- Move by headlamp through total darkness
- See natural rock formations and cave chambers
- Certified caving guide and all safety equipment provided
- No experience needed — beginner-friendly
- An adventurous half-day near Kutaisi
- Easy to combine with the canyons and waterfalls of Imereti / Samegrelo

Quick Facts

Duration	Full-day activity overall
Time inside the cave	3–5 hours (tailored to your group)
Start / End	Tbilisi or Kutaisi (two pickup options)
Location	Melouri Cave, near Kutaisi (Tskaltubo), Imereti
Group size	Private — your group only

Activity	Wild caving — wading, scrambling, total dark
Equipment	Helmet, headlamp, boots & overalls provided
Best for	Adventurous first-timers — no experience needed

Itinerary (day plan)

1. **Pickup — morning.** Meet your guide in Tbilisi or Kutaisi (meeting point confirmed on booking) and set off for the cave.
2. **Transfer to Melouri Cave — varies.** Drive to Melouri Cave near Kutaisi / Tskaltubo in Imereti — a short local transfer from Kutaisi, or a longer drive if starting from Tbilisi.
3. **Gear-up & safety briefing — ~20 min.** Helmet, headlamp and caving overalls are fitted, and your guide explains technique and safety before you head underground.
4. **Enter Melouri Cave.** Leave daylight behind and begin the underground route — first chambers, formations, and the way to the river passage.
5. **Wild caving — core of the day.** Cross the underground river, scramble over rock, and explore deeper with your guide — headlamp-only in the living dark.
6. **Exit & change — ~20 min.** Back to daylight, then change out of your muddy gear — the grinning-photo moment.
7. **Return transfer — afternoon / evening.** Return to Kutaisi or Tbilisi, depending on your pickup point.

Route: Pickup (Tbilisi or Kutaisi) → transfer to Melouri Cave → gear-up & safety briefing → enter the cave → underground river & chambers → exit & change → return transfer

What's Included

- Certified caving guide
- Helmet, headlamp, boots, gloves and caving overalls
- Local transfer to and from the cave
- Safety briefing, route planning and organisation

Not Included

- International flights
- Travel insurance
- Food and drinks
- Personal clothing (bring a full change)
- Personal expenses
- Optional extras
- Tips (discretionary)

What to Bring

- A full change of clothes
- A warm layer for afterwards
- Water and a snack
- Personal medication

Difficulty

Moderate — no experience required.

Expect to get a little muddy, step across water, and scramble over uneven ground, with some lower or tighter sections. You stay mostly dry — the provided boots keep your feet dry and you only cross the water rather than walk through it. Reasonable general fitness and comfort in enclosed, dark spaces are needed — this is a wild cave, so it is **not suitable for serious claustrophobia or significant mobility limits**. The cave runs year-round in virtually any weather.

Melouri has many possible routes, so the difficulty and time underground (roughly 3–5 hours) are tailored to your group — from a gentler line for first-timers to a longer, more demanding route for the adventurous.

Best Season

Month	Rating
May	Excellent
June	Excellent
July	Excellent
August	Excellent
September	Excellent
October	Excellent

Good to Know

- A genuine "wild" cave near Kutaisi — no lights or walkways
 - Bring your own water and a snack; no food is provided
 - Pairs naturally with Imereti's canyons and waterfalls
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FAQ

Do I need caving experience? No — this trip is beginner-friendly. A certified caving guide leads every step, explains technique in the safety briefing, and keeps the group safe throughout. You just need reasonable general fitness and a sense of adventure.

Is it safe — who leads it? A certified caving guide leads the whole experience, with all safety equipment provided and safety-checked. Every trip is private — your group only — and starts with a briefing.

Will I get wet? Not really. You don't walk through the water — you only step across it, and because we provide boots, your feet stay dry too. You might get slightly wet while crawling through the lower sections, but only a little. Overall you stay mostly dry.

Is it claustrophobic — are there tight squeezes? There are some lower and tighter sections, though much of the route is through walking-height passages and chambers. It is a genuine wild cave, so it is not recommended for those with serious claustrophobia. Tell us any concerns when you book.

How long are you inside the cave, and can the route be adjusted? You spend roughly 3–5 hours underground. Melouri has many possible routes, so your guide tailors both the difficulty and the length to your group — a shorter, easier line for first-timers, or a longer, more challenging route if you want more adventure.

What's the minimum age and fitness level? You should be reasonably fit and comfortable scrambling over uneven ground in the dark. Please ask us about minimum age and suitability when you enquire, and note any health or mobility concerns.

What should I wear and bring? Wear old sportswear you don't mind getting a little muddy. Bring a change of clothes, a warm layer for afterwards, water and a snack. Helmet, headlamp, boots and caving overalls are all provided.

Is equipment provided? Yes — helmet, headlamp, boots and caving overalls are all provided. You just bring old sportswear to wear underneath, a change of clothes, and a warm layer for afterwards.

Can I do this from Tbilisi, and how long is that day? Yes. From Kutaisi it's about a five-hour experience. From Tbilisi it becomes a long full day — Kutaisi is roughly 3.5–4 hours' drive each way — so expect an early start and a full day out. Choose your pickup point when you book.

Is this a private trip? Yes — every trip we run is private, just for you and your companions. No strangers, no mixed groups.

Does rain or bad weather affect the trip? No — rain and bad weather don't affect Melouri Cave. Thanks to the cave's structure, even during heavy rain the chance of flooding is effectively zero, so the trip runs as planned in virtually any weather.

Is it suitable for children or families? It can suit older children and teenagers who are comfortable getting little wet, muddy and being underground in the dark, but it is a real wild cave rather than a gentle show-cave. Tell us your group's ages and we'll advise honestly.
